

Eight weeks from first conversation to warm introduction

How the MVP1 build — AI fit-scoring, document verification, and warm introductions for retiring business owners and the buyers looking for them — maps to the technical and Agile skills the team is developing along the way, through beta feedback and Demo Day.

This roadmap follows the sequence in MatchBook's MVP1 AI hypothesis & intake spec. **The matching hypothesis itself is still preliminary** — validated so far by hand-matching real sellers and buyers, not by live product data — so Phase 0 exists to keep testing that before any code is load-bearing. The 8-week window is already aggressive; the team's stated intent is to compress it further wherever the build allows an earlier beta.

TECHNICAL SKILLS DEVELOPMENT

Core ML/AI Concepts

Weighting fit-score attributes, setting the 90%+ introduction threshold, and keeping bias (age, race, credentials) out of the matching logic.

Gen AI & Data Engineering

Using pre-trained LLMs — no model trained from scratch — to structure intake answers and read seller financial documents.

MLOps & Deployment

Hosting the MVP somewhere real beta testers can reach, and building the eval loop that proves the scoring actually works.

PROJECT-BASED LEARNING

Agile Scrum Methodology

Running the 8-week build as tracked sprints with a real backlog, not one undifferentiated push to Demo Day.

Team Collaboration

PM, Data Science, Engineering, Design, and GTM handing off one pipeline: intake → score → verify → introduce.

Real-World Applications

Every phase anchored to actual sellers and buyers — from Voice-of-Customer research through live beta feedback.

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WEEK 1 · PHASE 0

Discovery & Voice of Customer

Goal: confirm the problem is real before a line of matching code is written.

Seller & buyer VoC interviews and async surveys (live script + Google Form)
Competitor teardown — listing marketplaces, brokers, online acquisition platforms
Seller & buyer persona table finalized for recruiting
Hypothesis framed explicitly as unproven: better scoring + verification → higher-quality intros

Real-World Applications Team Collaboration Agile Scrum

WEEK 2 · PHASE 1

Intake schema & data foundations

Goal: turn what a seller or buyer says into data the AI can actually score.

Seller intake: business basics, financials, operations, assets/lease, customer quality, legal, deal terms

Buyer intake: profile, acquisition criteria, financial capacity, involvement, risk tolerance, deal preferences

First pass at hard disqualifiers vs. weighted preferences

Gen AI & Data Engineering Core ML/AI Concepts Agile Scrum

WEEKS 3-4 · PHASE 2

AI fit-scoring engine, v1

Goal: rank buyer-seller compatibility — building on existing LLMs, not training a model from zero.

Weighted scoring across industry, geography, financial capacity, SDE/cash-flow fit, risk tolerance, deal terms

Scoring logic tested against the pairs already hand-matched manually, before any AI existed

Bias exclusions enforced by default, not left to reviewer judgment

Core ML/AI Concepts Gen AI & Data Engineering MLOps & Deployment

Verification & explainability

Goal: don't just say "compatible" — show the evidence, and flag what's still a risk.

AI reads P&Ls, tax returns, and SDE/EBITDA to extract and cross-check seller-reported numbers

Red-flag detection: customer concentration, lease terms, liens, unusual contracts

Human-in-the-loop fallback whenever the AI isn't confident enough to auto-approve

"Why you're a strong match" explanation screen — ✓ fit signals and ⚠ open risks, side by side

Gen AI & Data Engineering Core ML/AI Concepts Team Collaboration



Warm introduction flow, shipped to beta

Goal: close the loop end to end, and put it in front of real users.

Full flow live: profile → qualification → fit score → verification → 90%+ match → warm intro

MVP hosted somewhere beta testers can actually reach — not a local demo

Sprint review against the original 8-week scope; cut anything that isn't load-bearing

MLOps & Deployment Agile Scrum Team Collaboration



Beta feedback

Goal: let real reactions, not internal assumptions, decide what ships next.

Beta cohort from the VoC-recruited waitlist plus Monique's existing seller/buyer network

Feedback synthesized into the top recurring pain points, seller-side and buyer-side

Demo narrative built from what beta testers actually did, not a hypothetical walkthrough

Real-World Applications Team Collaboration



Demo Day

Real sellers, real buyers, real feedback — presented live, not simulated.

BEYOND MVP1 — PRELIMINARY

Sequenced in the intake spec but not yet scoped week-by-week — deliberately looser than the plan above until MVP1's real usage data exists to plan against.



MVP2

Deal workspace & a learning loop

Deal workspace: NDA, document sharing, communication, diligence workflow

Every accepted or declined match becomes labeled data that retrains the scoring model

MLOps & Deployment Gen AI & Data Engineering



FUTURE

Deal-success prediction & financing match

Predict probability a matched deal actually progresses and closes

Connect qualified buyers to financing/lender options directly

Core ML/AI Concepts Real-World Applications